

BOOK TWO OF THREE FREE GUIDES

50 SIMPLE WAYS AI CAN HELP

Everyday AI

Fifty simple ways it can help around the house and beyond.
Each idea comes with the exact words to type.

By Joseph Conlan
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CloneCentre

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A note from Joseph

Hello again, Joseph Conlan here, from Clone Centre in Liverpool.

The first book in this series, AI in Plain English, explained what AI is and how to open your first AI chat. This one is the fun part: fifty real, practical things it can do for you, starting today.

Every idea in this book follows the same pattern. A title, a sentence or two about why it is useful, and then the exact words to type into an AI chat such as ChatGPT, Claude or Gemini. You can copy them word for word. Change the details to fit your own life and they work even better.

You will not use all fifty. Nobody does. Skim through, put a tick by the five or six that make you think "oh, that would actually help", and start with those. That is exactly how this is meant to work.

Warm regards,

Joseph Conlan Founder, Clone Centre, Liverpool clonecentre.ai

How to use this book

Each idea is a card. Under every one you will find a line beginning **Try typing:** followed by the exact words to send to your AI chat.

Two small tips before you start.

First, the more you tell it, the better the answer. "Suggest a recipe" gives you something generic. "Suggest a recipe for two people using chicken, rice and frozen peas, ready in half an hour" gives you dinner.

Second, you can always reply. If the answer is too long, say "shorter please". Too formal? "Make it friendlier." Wrong entirely? "No, I meant..." and explain again. It never minds.

In the Kitchen

1 What shall I cook tonight?

Tell the AI what is sitting in your fridge and cupboards, and it will suggest meals you can make right now. No more staring into the fridge hoping for inspiration.

TYPE THIS

"I have chicken thighs, potatoes, carrots, an onion and some cream. Suggest three simple dinners I could make, with easy instructions."

2 A week of meals on one page

Ask for a full week of evening meals matched to your tastes, with a combined shopping list. You can say how many people, what you dislike, and how long you want to spend cooking.

TYPE THIS

"Plan seven evening meals for two people who like plain, traditional cooking. Nothing spicy. Each meal under forty minutes. Give me one combined shopping list."

3 Recipes sized for one or two

Most recipes feed four or six. The AI will shrink any recipe down properly, adjusting the amounts and timings so nothing goes to waste.

TYPE THIS

"Give me a shepherd's pie recipe scaled down for one person, with a little left over for lunch the next day."

4 The mystery ingredient

Bought something at the market because it looked nice, and now you are not sure what to do with it? Describe it and ask.

TYPE THIS "What can I cook with celeriac? Give me three simple ideas for someone who has never used it before."

5 Baking rescue

Cake sunk in the middle? Pastry like leather? Describe what went wrong and it will usually tell you why, and how to fix it next time.

TYPE THIS "My scones always come out hard and flat. What am I likely doing wrong? Explain simply."

6 Special diets made simple

Cooking for a diabetic guest, someone avoiding gluten, or just cutting down on salt? Ask for ideas and adaptations in plain language.

TYPE THIS "My brother is diabetic and coming for Sunday lunch. Suggest a full menu he can enjoy, including pudding, that the rest of us will like too."

7 Use it up

Turn odds and ends into something tasty instead of binning them. Lovely for saving money and reducing waste.

TYPE THIS "I have half a loaf of stale bread, two eggs, some cheese and a few tomatoes. What can I make?"

8 Your own recipe book, tidied

Have recipes scrawled on envelopes and torn from magazines? Type them in and ask the AI to rewrite them neatly, all in the same clear format, ready to print.

TYPE THIS

"Rewrite this recipe neatly with a proper ingredients list and numbered steps: [paste your recipe here]."

Health and Wellbeing

A quick but important word before these ideas: AI is not a doctor. It cannot examine you, diagnose you or prescribe anything. What it can do is help you understand things, prepare for appointments, and build healthy habits. For anything that worries you about your health, please see your GP or pharmacist.

9 Get more from your GP appointment

Ten minutes with the doctor goes fast. The AI can help you organise your thoughts beforehand so you describe things clearly and remember your questions.

TYPE THIS

"Help me prepare for a GP appointment about my sore knee. It has hurt for six weeks and is worse on stairs. Make a short list of what to tell the doctor and what to ask."

10 Understand your medication leaflet

Those folded leaflets are written in tiny print and dense language. Type in the name of the medicine and ask for a plain English summary, then confirm anything important with your pharmacist.

TYPE THIS

"Explain in simple terms what [medicine name] is for, how and when to take it, and what common side effects to watch for. Keep it brief."

11 Explain that word the doctor used

Came home from an appointment with a word you did not understand? Ask for a simple explanation. Knowledge is a great calmer of nerves.

TYPE THIS "The doctor used the word [word]. Explain what it means in plain English, for someone with no medical background."

12 A gentle exercise plan

Ask for a safe, gentle routine suited to your age and ability, perhaps chair exercises or short walks. Show it to your GP or physiotherapist if you have any conditions.

TYPE THIS "I am 68 and not very active. Suggest a gentle ten minute morning routine I can do at home, with no equipment, to help with stiff joints."

13 Sleep better

Describe your sleep troubles and ask for practical, sensible suggestions. It can also explain good sleep habits in plain terms.

TYPE THIS "I fall asleep fine but wake at 4am and cannot get back to sleep. Give me practical tips that might help."

14 Eat well for your age

Ask for simple guidance on eating well after sixty, or for meal ideas that support a particular goal such as stronger bones or lower blood pressure.

TYPE THIS "Suggest a week of simple breakfasts and lunches that are good for bone health for a woman in her seventies."

15 Questions to ask the pharmacist

Before picking up a new prescription, prepare a short list of sensible questions so you leave the counter knowing exactly what you need to know.

TYPE THIS

"I have just been prescribed a new tablet alongside two others. What questions should I ask my pharmacist about taking them together?"

16 A calmer mind

The AI can talk you through simple relaxation and breathing exercises, suggest ways to unwind, or help you build a calming bedtime routine.

TYPE THIS

"Guide me through a simple five minute breathing exercise to help me relax. Write it out so I can follow it step by step."

17 Understanding test results letters

Hospital letters are full of abbreviations. Type in the confusing parts and ask what they mean, then check your understanding with the surgery.

TYPE THIS

"My hospital letter says [paste the sentence]. Explain what this means in everyday language."

Money and Paperwork

18 Understand a bill or statement

Paste in the confusing part of a gas bill, bank statement or insurance renewal and ask what it actually says. No more nodding along and hoping.

TYPE THIS

"Explain this part of my energy bill in plain English: [paste the text]. Am I being charged more than before?"

19 Write a complaint letter that works

A clear, calm, well structured complaint gets results far more often than an angry one. Tell the AI the story and it will draft the letter.

TYPE THIS

"Write a firm but polite complaint letter to my broadband company. The service has failed four times this month and I spent two hours on hold. Ask for a refund for the downtime."

20 Check what you might be entitled to

Many people miss out on help such as Pension Credit or Attendance Allowance because the forms are daunting. The AI can explain what exists and how to apply, in plain steps.

TYPE THIS

"I am 74 and live alone on a state pension. What benefits or discounts might I be missing out on in the UK? List them simply with how to apply for each."

21

Decode official letters

Council tax, HMRC, the DVLA: official letters often bury the one thing you must do. Paste it in and ask.

TYPE THIS

"Here is a letter from the council: [paste text]. Tell me in one or two sentences what they want me to do and by when."

22

Make a simple budget

Tell it your weekly or monthly income and your main costs, and it will lay out a clear, simple budget and suggest where money quietly leaks away.

TYPE THIS

"Help me make a simple monthly budget. My pension is [amount] a month. My main costs are roughly [list them]. Show me what is left and where I could save a little."

23

Get ready for a phone call

Dreading a call to the bank or the phone company? Ask the AI to write out what to say, including what to do if they fob you off.

TYPE THIS

"I have to ring my insurer to question a price rise. Write a short script of what to say, including polite replies if they say no."

24

Understand a financial word

Annuity, equity release, compound interest: ask for any of them explained simply, with a small example.

TYPE THIS

"Explain what equity release means in plain English, with a simple example, and mention the main things to be careful about."

25

Organise your paperwork

Ask for a simple system for keeping bills, guarantees and important papers in order, or a checklist of documents your family would need if anything happened to you.

TYPE THIS

"Give me a simple checklist of the important documents every household should keep together, and where to keep copies."

Hobbies and Gardening

26

What to do in the garden this month

Tell it where you live and what you grow, and it will give you a month by month list of jobs: sowing, pruning, feeding and protecting.

TYPE THIS

"I live in the north west of England and have a small garden with roses and a veg patch. What jobs should I do this month?"

27

Identify that plant

Describe a plant, its leaves, flowers and where it is growing, and the AI will suggest what it might be and how to care for it.

TYPE THIS

"There is a plant in my garden about knee height with purple spikes of flowers and greyish leaves. What might it be, and how do I look after it?"

28 Learn a new craft from scratch

Always fancied watercolour painting, knitting, calligraphy or woodwork? Ask for a beginner's guide with exactly what to buy first.

TYPE THIS

"I want to learn watercolour painting as a complete beginner. Give me a shopping list of cheap starter supplies and three first exercises."

29 Plan the perfect plot

Allotment holders and veg growers can ask for a planting plan matched to the space, the season and what you actually like eating.

TYPE THIS

"Plan a beginner's veg patch of about two metres by three. I like potatoes, beans, salads and courgettes. Show me what to plant where and when."

30 Unblock your writing

Whether it is a memoir for the grandchildren, a poem or a short story, the AI will help you plan, suggest openings and gently improve your drafts.

TYPE THIS

"I want to write down memories of my childhood in 1960s Liverpool for my grandchildren. Help me make a simple plan of ten chapters with prompts for each."

31 Solve the crossword clue

Stuck on a clue? Ask for help. It can also explain how cryptic clues work, which is half the battle.

TYPE THIS

"Help me with this crossword clue: [type the clue, the number of letters, and any letters you have]. Explain your reasoning."

32**Photograph it better**

Ask for simple tips to take better photos of the garden, the grandchildren or your holidays with the phone you already own.

TYPE THIS

"Give me five simple tips for taking better photos of my grandchildren with my phone. Keep them easy to remember."

33**Fix it yourself (the simple things)**

Describe the wobbly chair, the dripping tap or the squeaky door and ask for safe, simple fixes, plus clear guidance on when to call a professional instead.

TYPE THIS

"My kitchen tap drips steadily. Explain how I might fix it myself in simple steps, and when I should give up and call a plumber."

34**Family history detective**

Ask how to start tracing your family tree, which records to look for, and how to organise what you find.

TYPE THIS

"I want to research my family history starting from my grandparents in Liverpool. Give me a simple step by step plan for a beginner, including free resources."

Family and Keeping in Touch

35 Write a proper letter

Birthday letters, thank you letters, a note to an old friend you have lost touch with. Tell it the person and the feeling, and it will help you find the words.

TYPE THIS

"Help me write a warm letter to an old friend I have not seen in twenty years. We worked together at the docks. Suggest what to say to reopen the friendship."

36 The right words for a card

Christenings, weddings, condolences, get well soon: some cards are hard to write. The AI will suggest several versions so you can pick the one that sounds like you.

TYPE THIS

"Suggest three short, kind messages for a sympathy card for a neighbour whose husband has died. Sincere, not flowery."

37 A speech to be proud of

Father of the bride, a milestone birthday, a retirement do. Give it your stories and it will shape them into a speech you will actually enjoy giving.

TYPE THIS

"Help me write a five minute speech for my wife's 70th birthday party. Warm and funny. Here are three stories about her: [tell your stories]."

38**Understand the grandchildren**

What is that game they are always on? What does that word they keep saying mean? Ask, and join their world a little.

TYPE THIS

"My grandson keeps talking about a game called Minecraft. Explain what it is, whether it is suitable for a ten year old, and what I could ask him about it."

39**Gifts they will genuinely like**

Describe the person, their age and what they love, and get a list of thoughtful ideas at your budget, far better than another pair of socks.

TYPE THIS

"Suggest ten birthday gifts for a 16 year old girl who loves music and art, at around twenty pounds each."

40**Plan the family gathering**

Christmas dinner for nine, a anniversary party, a picnic: ask for a plan covering food, timings and who could bring what.

TYPE THIS

"Plan a family Sunday lunch for eight people including two small children and one vegetarian. Give me a menu, a cooking timetable and a shopping list."

41**Help with homework (from a distance)**

When a grandchild asks about the Romans or fractions at the wrong moment, the AI will explain it at exactly the right level for their age.

TYPE THIS

"Explain the water cycle to a curious eight year old, simply and clearly, in a way I could tell them over the phone."

42

Rekindle old friendships

Not sure how to get back in touch with someone after years? Ask for a first message that feels natural rather than awkward.

TYPE THIS

"Write a short, friendly first message to an old workmate I found online after thirty years. Light and easy, no pressure to reply."

43

Settle a friendly argument

Who won the cup in 1965? What year did that song come out? Ask and end the debate at the lunch table in seconds. (Check the answer if money is riding on it.)

TYPE THIS

"Settle an argument: [ask your question]. Give the answer simply, with a little background."

Out and About

44

Plan a day trip

Tell it your town, how far you will travel and what you enjoy, and it will suggest a full day out with lunch included.

TYPE THIS

"Plan a day trip within an hour of Liverpool for two people in their sixties who like history and a good pub lunch. Suggest two options."

45

Holidays without the headache

Ask for itineraries matched to your pace: gentle sightseeing, good food, not too much walking, with practical tips for getting around.

TYPE THIS

"Plan three gentle days in York for an older couple. We like history, tea rooms and short walks. Suggest where to visit each day and where to eat."

46

Pack properly every time

Ask for a packing list tailored to the trip, the weather and your needs, including the things everyone forgets.

TYPE THIS

"Make me a packing list for a week in Devon in September. I walk a lot, take daily medication and like to be ready for rain."

47

Decode the travel small print

Paste in the baffling bits of a booking confirmation or travel insurance policy and ask what matters, especially what is not covered.

TYPE THIS

"Here is part of my travel insurance policy: [paste text]. Explain in plain English what is covered and what the main exclusions are."

48

A phrase or two abroad

Going somewhere new? Ask for the dozen most useful phrases with simple pronunciations, plus local etiquette tips so you feel at ease.

TYPE THIS

"I am going to Portugal. Give me twelve essential Portuguese phrases with easy pronunciations, and three etiquette tips visitors should know."

49

Find what is on near you

Ask what kinds of clubs, classes and groups exist locally for your interests, from u3a and walking groups to choirs and bowls.

TYPE THIS

"What sorts of clubs and activities are usually available in UK towns for someone over 60 who likes walking, singing and history? Suggest how to find local ones."

50

Never be stuck for words with tech again

The most useful habit of all: whenever any technology confuses you, describe the problem to your AI chat exactly as you see it, and ask for simple steps.

TYPE THIS

"My phone keeps saying storage is full. Explain in simple steps how an older, non technical person can free up space."

About Clone Centre

Clone Centre is an independent AI consultancy based in Liverpool, founded by Joseph Conlan.

We help ordinary people and small organisations understand and use artificial intelligence, without the jargon and without the hard sell. That includes friendly training sessions, one to one help getting set up, and practical advice for small businesses wondering what AI could actually do for them.

If you enjoyed this book, you may like the other two in the series: AI in Plain English: A Friendly Guide for the Over 50s, and Safe and Sound: How to Spot AI Scams and Protect Yourself Online.

You can find us, and get in touch, at **clonecentre.ai**.

Fifty ideas is only the start. Once you are comfortable, you will find yourself asking it about everything. We would love to hear what you use it for.